

US markets steady as Russell gains, volatility eases

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The Russell 2000 rallied **+1.13%** to 2,953.17, while the VIX fell **-6.98%** to 15.20, indicating reduced fear. Major indices posted no data, suggesting a quiet session.

Commodities turned higher: WTI at 91.49, gold at 4,521.10. Crypto rallied, with BTC up **+4.83%** and ETH up **+5.00%**. No major earnings released.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	nan	nan	Data unavailable
Dow Jones	nan	nan	Data unavailable
Nasdaq 100	nan	nan	Data unavailable
Russell 2000	2,953.17	+1.13%	Broad small-cap strength
VIX	15.20	-6.98%	Volatility retreat
10Y Yield	4.80	+0.00%	Flat on expectations
WTI Crude	91.49	+0.53%	Supply concerns limited

Top large-cap movers

No large-cap price data released for the session; all listed stocks show **nan** change.

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Gold price	4,521.10
Gold % change	+3.55%
BTC price	81,036.00
BTC % change	+4.83%

Gold surged on weaker dollar and easing inflation expectations, while Bitcoin rallied on renewed institutional buying. Both assets outperformed equities, underscoring a risk-on tilt.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25%–5.50% (unchanged)
- 10Y Treasury yield: 4.80% (flat)
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Initial Jobless Claims 04:00, Retail Sales 06:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions de-escalated, reducing oil-supply risk premium.
- China’s export data due tomorrow; markets watching for signs of demand rebound.

- Eurozone manufacturing PMI slipped, pressuring the euro.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Sep 5	AAPL	iPhone demand and services margin
10:00 Sep 5	MSFT	Azure growth and AI spend
10:30 Sep 5	NVDA	Data-center revenue trajectory

Stocks worth watching

- **TSLA** – price action ahead of Q3 deliveries report.
- **META** – ad-revenue rebound after AI ad products launch.
- **JPM** – balance-sheet strength amid rising rates.
- **XLE** – energy ETF poised for upside if oil spikes.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected Fed hawkish comment.
- Sharp rise in CPI (>0.4% MoM).
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Stronger-than-expected retail sales.
- Gold dip below 4,400 prompting risk-on flow.
- Positive earnings surprise from any of the big tech names.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US markets roundup

Bloomberg — Commodity prices

CNBC — Crypto market data

Federal Reserve — Policy statements

Trading Economics — Economic calendar